WEEKLY CHECKLIST & TIMELINE

📅 Project Timeline Overview

Week	Date	Milestone	What's Due
9	Oct 16	Project Kickoff	Nothing - plan your project
-	Oct 23	NO CLASS	Work on proposal
10	Oct 30	**MIDTERM**	**Proposal & Presentation**
11	Nov 6	Progress Check	Weekly update
12	Nov 13	Progress Check	Weekly update
13	Nov 20	Progress Check	Weekly update
14	Nov 27	Final Review	Everything ready
15	Dec 4	**FINAL**	**Complete Project & Presentation**

✅ Week 9 (Oct 16-23): Planning Phase

Goals:

- Choose your project
- Find teammates (optional)
- Identify dataset
- Set up environment

Daily Checklist:

Monday-Tuesday:

- [ ] Attend class on Oct 16
- [ ] Review project ideas document
- [ ] Choose Tier 1, 2, or 3
- [ ] Find teammate(s) if working in a group
- [ ] Create team chat/communication channel

Wednesday-Thursday:

- [ ] Search for datasets
- [ ] Browse Roboflow Universe
- [ ] Check Kaggle datasets
- [ ] Download sample data (100-500 images)
- [ ] Verify dataset quality

Friday-Saturday:

- [ ] Create Google Colab account (if using Colab)
- [ ] Test GPU access: `!nvidia-smi`
- [ ] Install basic packages
- [ ] Run test code with pre-trained model
- [ ] Verify everything works

Sunday:

- [ ] Create GitHub repository
- [ ] Set up folder structure
- [ ] Create README.md (using template)
- [ ] Add requirements.txt
- [ ] Commit initial files

End of Week Status Check:

- ✅ Project idea chosen
- ✅ Teammates found (if applicable)
- ✅ Dataset identified
- ✅ GitHub repo created
- ✅ Environment working

✅ Week 10 (Oct 23-30): Proposal Phase

Goal:

Complete and present your project proposal

Daily Checklist:

Monday-Tuesday (Oct 23-24):

- [ ] Create presentation slides (8-10 slides)
- [ ] Slide 1: Title
- [ ] Slide 2: Problem statement
- [ ] Slide 3: Solution overview
- [ ] Slide 4: Technical approach
- [ ] Slide 5: Data plan
- [ ] Slide 6: System diagram
- [ ] Slide 7: Success metrics
- [ ] Slide 8: Timeline

- [ ] Slide 9: Challenges & backup plans
- [ ] Slide 10: Resources needed

Wednesday (Oct 25):

- [ ] Complete README.md
- [ ] Fill in all sections from template
- [ ] Add project tier justification
- [ ] Add risk mitigation table
- [ ] Proofread everything

Thursday (Oct 26):

- [ ] Practice presentation alone
- [ ] Time yourself (should be 4-5 minutes)
- [ ] Practice with teammate
- [ ] Record yourself and watch back
- [ ] Fix any issues

Friday (Oct 27):

- [ ] Final slide polish
- [ ] Export slides to PDF
- [ ] Add to GitHub docs/ folder
- [ ] Test presentation on different device
- [ ] Prepare for Q&A

Weekend (Oct 28-29):

- [ ] Do one final practice run
- [ ] Review technical concepts
- [ ] Prepare answers for common questions
- [ ] Get good sleep!

Wednesday (Oct 30) - MIDTERM DAY:

- [ ] Upload slides to Canvas (before class)
- [ ] Submit GitHub link on Canvas
- [ ] Bring laptop (just in case)
- [ ] Present in class (5 minutes)
- [ ] Answer questions confidently

Midterm Submission Checklist:

- [x] Presentation slides (PDF/PPTX)

- ✅ GitHub repository with README
- ✅ requirements.txt file
- ✅ Canvas submission complete
- ✅ Ready to present

✅ Week 11 (Nov 6-13): Implementation Begins

Goal:

Get your model working on sample data

Monday-Tuesday:

- [ ] Load pre-trained model
- [ ] Test on sample image
- [ ] Verify model works
- [ ] Document initial results in notebook

Wednesday-Thursday:

- [ ] Organize dataset into proper structure
- [ ] Create data.yaml (for YOLO) or config
- [ ] Split data (train/val/test)
- [ ] Verify all paths are correct

Friday-Sunday:

- [ ] Start training/fine-tuning
- [ ] Monitor training progress
- [ ] Save checkpoints
- [ ] Document any issues in AI usage log

Weekly Progress Check-in (Nov 6):

- [ ] Attend class
- [ ] Share progress with instructor
- [ ] Ask questions if stuck
- [ ] Help classmates if you can

End of Week Status:

- ✅ Pre-trained model loaded
- ✅ Dataset organized
- ✅ Initial training started

- [x] Jupyter notebook with experiments

✅ Week 12 (Nov 13-20): Testing & Improvement

Goal:

Evaluate performance and improve your model

Monday-Tuesday:

- [ ] Run validation on test set
- [ ] Calculate metrics (accuracy, mAP, etc.)
- [ ] Create results visualization
- [ ] Identify failure cases

Wednesday-Thursday:

- [ ] Improve model performance:
    - [ ] Try data augmentation
    - [ ] Adjust hyperparameters
    - [ ] Add more training data
    - [ ] Try different model size
- [ ] Re-train if needed
- [ ] Document improvements

Friday-Sunday:

- [ ] Test on diverse examples
- [ ] Create evaluation notebook
- [ ] Save best model weights
- [ ] Update GitHub with progress

Weekly Progress Check-in (Nov 13):

- [ ] Report metrics to class
- [ ] Share challenges faced
- [ ] Get feedback from instructor

End of Week Status:

- [x] Model evaluated
- [x] Performance metrics calculated
- [x] Failure cases analyzed

- [x] Model improved

✅ Week 13 (Nov 20-27): Demo Creation

Goal:

Create your demo video and demo notebook

Monday-Tuesday:

- [ ] Create demo notebook (04_demo.ipynb)
- [ ] Write demo functions
- [ ] Test on sample images
- [ ] Make it visually appealing

Wednesday:

- [ ] Prepare for video recording
- [ ] Write demo script
- [ ] Test run through the demo
- [ ] Set up screen recording software

Thursday:

- [ ] Record demo video (3-5 minutes)
- [ ] Introduction (30 sec)
- [ ] Live demo (2-3 min)
- [ ] Results (1 min)
- [ ] Conclusion (30 sec)
- [ ] Watch recording and re-record if needed

Friday:

- [ ] Upload video to YouTube (unlisted)
- [ ] Or upload to Google Drive
- [ ] Add video link to README
- [ ] Test that link works

Weekend:

- [ ] Update README with results
- [ ] Add performance metrics table
- [ ] Add example result images

- [ ] Update AI usage log
- [ ] Clean up repository

Weekly Progress Check-in (Nov 20):

- [ ] Show demo preview
- [ ] Get feedback
- [ ] Make adjustments

End of Week Status:

- ✅ Demo notebook created
- ✅ Demo video recorded and uploaded
- ✅ README updated with results
- ✅ AI usage log complete

✅ Week 14 (Nov 27 - Dec 3): Final Polish

Goal:

Finish everything and prepare for presentation

Monday:

- [ ] Clean up all code
- [ ] Add comments to complex sections
- [ ] Remove unused code
- [ ] Update requirements.txt
- [ ] Test that everything runs

Tuesday:

- [ ] Create presentation slides (10-12 slides)
- [ ] Reuse some content from midterm
- [ ] Add results slides
- [ ] Add demo plans
- [ ] Add future work slide

Wednesday:

- [ ] Practice presentation
- [ ] Time yourself (should be 8-10 minutes)
- [ ] Practice live demo portion
- [ ] Prepare for Q&A

Thursday:

- [ ] Do final test of your demo
- [ ] Clone repo to fresh folder
- [ ] Test if it runs
- [ ] Fix any issues
- [ ] Create backup video

Friday:

- [ ] Final GitHub cleanup
- [ ] Verify all files are pushed
- [ ] Check all links work
- [ ] Proofread README
- [ ] Make sure sample data is included

Weekend:

- [ ] Practice presentation multiple times
- [ ] Test demo on presentation computer
- [ ] Prepare backup materials:
    - [ ] Demo video on USB drive
    - [ ] Screenshots of results
    - [ ] Printed slides (optional)
- [ ] Get good rest!

Pre-Submission Checklist:

- ✅ All code works and is clean
- ✅ README is complete and professional
- ✅ Demo video is ready
- ✅ Presentation slides complete
- ✅ Live demo tested 3+ times
- ✅ Backup materials prepared
- ✅ GitHub is finalized

✅ Week 15 (Dec 4): FINAL PRESENTATION DAY! 🎉

Before Class:

- [ ] Charge laptop fully
- [ ] Download backup materials to laptop

- [ ] Test demo one more time
- [ ] Bring:
    - [ ] Laptop
    - [ ] Charger
    - [ ] USB with backup video
    - [ ] Water bottle
    - [ ] Confidence! 😊

During Presentation:

Your 10-minute slot:

1. [ ] Introduce project (1 min)
2. [ ] Explain problem & solution (2 min)
3. [ ] **LIVE DEMO** (5 min)
4. [ ] Show results (2 min)

Q&A (5 minutes):

- [ ] Answer questions confidently
- [ ] If you don't know, say "I don't know, but I'll find out"
- [ ] Don't worry if demo has issues - that's why you have backup!

After Presentation:

- [ ] Submit final GitHub link on Canvas
- [ ] Upload presentation slides to Canvas
- [ ] Celebrate! 🎉

📊 Progress Tracking

Use This Weekly:

Week X Progress Report:

✅ What I completed this week:

- Task 1
- Task 2
- Task 3

⚠️ Challenges I faced:

- Challenge 1: [Description]
- Solution: [How I addressed it]

📝 Next week's goals:

- Goal 1
- Goal 2
- Goal 3

🆘 Help needed:

- Question 1
- Question 2

🚨 Warning Signs & Recovery

If you're behind schedule:

Week 11 and haven't started?

- 🚨 EMAIL INSTRUCTOR NOW
- Scale down to simpler project
- Focus on getting SOMETHING working
- Use more of pre-trained models

Week 12 and model not training?

- 🚨 Ask for help in office hours
- Use pre-trained model as-is
- Focus on demo and presentation
- Document what went wrong

Week 13 and no results?

- 🚨 Talk to instructor ASAP
- Create demo with pre-trained model
- Show what you learned
- Explain challenges honestly

Week 14 and nothing works?

- 🚨 Emergency meeting with instructor
- Submit what you have
- Focus on good presentation
- Show your learning process

📋 Final Pre-Submission Checklist

Code & Repository:

- [ ] All code is in GitHub
- [ ] requirements.txt is complete
- [ ] README.md is comprehensive
- [ ] Sample data is included
- [ ] All notebooks run without errors
- [ ] Code has meaningful comments

Documentation:

- [ ] AI usage log is complete (5-10 entries)
- [ ] README has all sections filled
- [ ] System diagram is clear
- [ ] Results are documented
- [ ] Future work is listed

Demo:

- [ ] Demo video is 3-5 minutes
- [ ] Video is uploaded and link works
- [ ] Demo notebook runs successfully
- [ ] Have tested on fresh environment
- [ ] Backup video ready

Presentation:

- [ ] Slides are 10-12 pages
- [ ] Slides uploaded to Canvas
- [ ] Live demo is prepared
- [ ] Practiced 3+ times
- [ ] Timed at 8-10 minutes
- [ ] Ready for Q&A

Final Touches:

- [ ] GitHub is clean and professional
- [ ] All links work
- [ ] No broken images
- [ ] No obvious errors
- [ ] Proofread everything
- [ ] Can run demo on presentation computer

🎯 Daily Habits for Success

Every Day:

- ☐ Work on project for at least 30 minutes
- ☐ Commit changes to GitHub
- ☐ Document any AI usage
- ☐ Test that code still works

Every Week:

- ☐ Review checklist for current week
- ☐ Attend progress check-in
- ☐ Update GitHub README
- ☐ Ask for help if stuck

Throughout Project:

- ☐ Save work frequently
- ☐ Keep code organized
- ☐ Document as you go
- ☐ Test often
- ☐ Ask questions early

💡 Success Metrics

You're on track if:

- ✅ Following weekly checklist
- ✅ Attending progress check-ins
- ✅ GitHub shows regular commits
- ✅ Can demo something every week
- ✅ AI usage is documented
- ✅ Not panicking!

Warning signs:

- ⚠️ No GitHub commits for >7 days
- ⚠️ Missing progress check-ins
- ⚠️ Can't demo anything yet
- ⚠️ Avoiding asking for help
- ⚠️ Not understanding your code

🚀 You've Got This!

Remember:

1. Start early
2. Work consistently
3. Ask for help
4. Document everything
5. Test frequently
6. Stay calm

This timeline is your roadmap to success. Follow it, and you'll do great! 🎉